

Wizard Cat: Cat Wizard

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1 The game

Working title: "Wizard Cat: Cat Wizard"

In our game, you will play a cat whose goal is to break into wizard houses, fight their familiars, steal their possessions, and beat them up. You'll come back to cause more chaos. Our target aesthetics are challenge and discovery, which we'll develop through combat and story elements.

In-game, Bartholo-mew is a wizard cat (cat wizard) who really hates Mayor Wizard of Wizard Town. He has decided to break into the wizard houses of the wizard residents of Wizard Town to steal their wizard things. He will battle with the wizard resident's wizard familiars with his magic wizard bullets, using their items to grow his wizard powers. In the process, he will discover secrets about Wizard Town... and himself (He is a cat wizard).

2 Scope

2.1 Must:

- Wizard cat(Bartholo-mew)
- Houses to break into
- Enemies
- Loot
- Spells / Combat
- Level transitions
- Loss state
- Health tracking
- Title screen
- Tutorial level
- Win condition
- Final boss

2.2 Want:

- Player evolution
- Dialogue/story/lore
- Map
- Home base
- Shop for item exchange
- Boss fights
- Buddy/familiar
- Potions or boosters
- Nice looking art
- Visually unique houses (themed tile sets)
- Fun sprite outfits
- Puzzles to unlock bonus loot

2.3 Won't:

- Unbalanced difficulty
- Dream too big
- Steal art
- Microtransactions

3 Design detail

Our core mechanics will be shooting magic bullets and spells at enemies (wizards and their familiars), looting money and potions from the houses of the wizards,

and exploring. The dynamics we would expect to emerge are combat strategies (strafing and dodging), inventory management (limited number of potions), and investigation of setting (to discover loot).

4 The road to the gates

Stage	Date	What exists
Prototype	October 15	A core combat loop, including enemies, health, and wizard bullets to enable combat. Basic setting: at least one house to fight in, with different rooms and loot. Basic HUD/UI
Alpha	November 5	Level selection (or a "home base" to return to between levels), combat with different spells and potential upgrades, core sprite assets created and variations if possible. More than one level and progression between them. Save function. Multiple spells with distinct behavior.
Beta	November 19	Polished visuals and behavior, as many levels as possible with variation between them, an established start/end point (final boss Wizard Mayor?), advanced animations for inventory and health if possible.

5 Risks and division of labor

Our top three risks, each with a mitigation, and who owns what (systems, art, levels, audio, integration).

Risks:

- Merge conflicts
 - Mitigation: use pull requests (discussed in logistics) and resolve merge conflicts together as needed. When possible, message or communicate in person with details when we are making changes (especially if they are not large enough to merit their own pull requests)
- Unfair division of labor

- Mitigation: discuss responsibilities and redistribute work as needed, be transparent with each other about how progress is going and whether we feel like the divide is fair at each stage
- Falling behind on schedule
 - Mitigation: plan soft deadlines for ourselves ahead of time, communicate about responsibilities and ability to complete tasks, reach out to Professor Cordova if needed

Ownership: We will divide asset sourcing or creation responsibilities as they come up (e.g. tile sets, sprites, audio) and keep a checklist of what we will need to make sure all relevant pieces are created once. We will start by using the proposal to create an outline of the game so that we can understand what our initial needs are.

6 Logistics

We will create pull requests for large feature additions or overall changes, and for smaller updates we will merge directly to main but keep each other updated to avoid merge conflicts. We will also check in frequently in order to stay on the same page about what has been done and what our priorities are. We will attempt to create our own assets (such as sprites and backgrounds), and use licensed assets to supplement if needed.